CHAPTER

06

Personality

Why is one classmate always calm while another worries about everything? Why does one person love meeting new people while another prefers to stay alone? **Personality** explains these lasting differences. The module quotes Shannon Alder: "One of the greatest regrets in life is being what others would want you to be, rather than being yourself." This chapter defines personality and presents three major theories: **psychoanalytic** (Freud), **trait** (the Big Five) and **humanistic** (Rogers and Maslow).

LESSONS IN THIS CHAPTER

6.1 The Meaning of Personality

6.2 Freud's Psychoanalytic Theory: Id, Ego and Superego

6.3 Defence Mechanisms

6.4 Trait Theory: The Big Five

6.5 The Humanistic Theory of Personality

Freshman A+ · General Psychology (Psyc 1011)

CHAPTER 6 · LESSON 6.1

The Meaning of Personality



AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Define personality and its origin
- Distinguish personality, character and temperament
- Explain why personality theories differ

6.1.1 Definition

D PERSONALITY

The word comes from **persona**, the theatrical **mask** worn by Greek actors. **Personality** is the **unique pattern of enduring thoughts, feelings and actions** that characterizes a person. It is not a loose collection of independent traits but an **organized whole**, and it makes each person different from others.

Term	Meaning	Example
Personality	the whole unique, enduring pattern of thinking, feeling and acting	Selam is friendly, organized and curious
Character	**value judgements** about a person's **morals** or ethical behaviour	"Selam is honest and trustworthy"
Temperament	the **inborn**, enduring characteristics a person is born with	irritability or adaptability seen from infancy

! DEFINITION TRAPS

- **Temperament** is **inborn**; it does **not** develop through experience. **Character** is a moral evaluation, not inborn features.
- Personality is **not** "a collection of independent attributes"; it is an organized, unique whole.

Different theories ask different questions and use different methods. This chapter covers three:

Theory	Personality comes from...
Psychoanalytic (Freud)	**unconscious** inner forces and conflicts; early childhood
Trait (Big Five)	a combination of **stable internal characteristics**
Humanistic (Rogers, Maslow)	**conscious**, self-motivated striving for growth; inherent goodness and free will

Exam Practice

5 QUESTIONS · LESSON 6.1

1 Arba Minch University · Final 2016

Character refers to the enduring features with which each person is born.

True / False

2 Arba Minch University · Final 2015

Temperament differs from character in that it develops through experience.

True / False

3 Wolaita Sodo University · Final 2014

Which statement is NOT true about personality?

A) Personality is a collection of independent attributes
B) Personality is not a simple mixture of different characteristics
C) Personality is a unique, enduring pattern
D) Personality makes individuals different from one another

4 Dilla University · Mid 2015

We humans differ from one another because of our personality.

True / False

5 Model question (module)

The word "personality" is derived from "persona", which originally referred to:

A) the soul
B) a theatrical mask worn by actors
C) the unconscious mind
D) a person's reputation

Answers & Explanations

1. False

Inborn features are temperament. Character is a judgement about a person's morals.

2. False

Temperament is inborn; it does not come from experience.

3. A

Personality is a collection of independent attributes

Personality is an organized, integrated whole, not a set of unrelated parts.

4. True

Personality is the unique pattern that distinguishes each individual.

5. B

a theatrical mask worn by actors

Greek actors wore masks (personae) to show different characters.

CHAPTER 6 · LESSON 6.2

Freud's Psychoanalytic Theory: Id, Ego and Superego

AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Explain Freud's view that personality arises from inner conflict
- Describe the id, ego and superego and their principles
- Identify which structure dominates a behaviour
- Describe the psychosexual stages often tested in exams

6.2.1 The structure of personality

According to **Sigmund Freud**, personality arises from **inborn** needs and drives, and people are in **constant conflict** between their biological urges and the need to control them. Behaviour is **not freely chosen**; it is determined by **intra-psychic** (inner) forces. Personality has three parts that develop at different times.

ID, EGO AND SUPEREGO

	Id ("it")	Ego ("I")	Superego ("over the self")
Develops	present **at birth**; the **first, most primitive** part	develops as the child deals with reality (about age 2)	develops in the **preschool** years as the child learns society's rules
Consciousness	completely **unconscious**	mostly **conscious**	partly conscious
Principle	**pleasure principle**: immediate satisfaction, no regard for consequences ("if it feels good, do it")	**reality principle**: satisfy the id only in ways that avoid negative consequences ("do it, but only if you can get away with it")	**moral principle**: right and wrong
Role	biological drives: hunger, thirst, sex, aggression; its energy is **libido**	the **executive director** / "**internal diplomat**": rational, logical; **balances** the id's demands with reality and the superego	the **moral watchdog**: two parts, the **ego ideal** (the standard of ideal behaviour) and the **conscience** (pride when right, **guilt** when wrong)

THE 6-MONTH-OLD AND THE 2-YEAR-OLD

A **6-month-old** sees an object and grabs it despite her parent's "No, no!" She has only the **id**. A **2-year-old** hears "No!" and pulls her hand back, then waits until the parent is not looking before grabbing it. Her **ego** is working: she wants the object but avoids punishment (reality principle). Years later, she may not take it at all because she feels it is **wrong** (superego).

WHICH STRUCTURE IS IN CONTROL? (ARSI 2014 / JIGJIGA)

(a) A woman cries loudly at the funeral of a stranger because that is what is expected. (b) A drug addict uses drugs regardless of the consequences. (c) A person helps people in need because she would feel guilty otherwise.

Step 1: Ask what the behaviour is serving. **Immediate pleasure** regardless of consequences → **id**. A **realistic compromise** → **ego**. **Moral rules and social expectations**, guilt or pride → **superego**.

(a) She follows social and moral expectations → **superego**. (b) Immediate gratification without regard for consequences → **id**. (c) Guilt and moral duty → **superego**, specifically the **conscience**.

6.2.2 Freud's psychosexual stages (often tested)

Freud believed personality develops through stages in which the id's pleasure-seeking energy focuses on different **erogenous zones** (body areas that give pleasure). Unresolved conflict at a stage can cause **fixation**, leaving traces in adult personality.

Stage (approx. age)	Focus	Key conflict	Possible adult fixation
Oral (0–1)	mouth: sucking, feeding	**weaning** (losing the breast or bottle)	dependency, smoking, overeating, nail-biting
Anal (1–3)	anus: toilet training	control and order	very neat, orderly, stubborn (or messy, careless)
Phallic (3–6)	genitals	**Oedipus / Electra** conflict; **gender identity** develops	vanity, inappropriate sexual behaviour; "mama's boy"
Latency (6–puberty)	sexual urges are **quiet**; energy goes into **school, play and friendships**	developing social and intellectual skills	
Genital (puberty on)	mature sexual relationships		

! PSYCHOANALYTIC TRAPS

- The **ego** is concerned with **reality**; concern with **rules and culture** is the **superego**.
- The **id**, not the ego, is the first, primitive, pleasure-seeking part.
- The superego works on the **moral** principle; the ego on the **reality** principle.
- Psychoanalytic theory does **not** see personality as a set of stable traits (that is trait theory); it does **not** attribute personality mainly to biological evolution.
- **Neatness and perfectionism** relate to the **anal** stage, not the phallic stage.

Exam Practice

16 QUESTIONS · LESSON 6.2

1 Wolaita Sodo University · Final 2014

In Freud's theory, the ego operates according to the _____ principle.

A) pleasure **B)** reality
C) religion **D)** morality

2 Jigjiga University · Final (Set A)

Which structure of personality operates by the moral principle?

A) Ego **B)** Id
C) Superego **D)** All of them

3 Wolaita Sodo University · Final 2014

The ego is the first, most primitive and pleasure-oriented part of personality.

True / False

4 Arsi University · Final 2014

Which of the following best explains the ego?

A) It is totally unconscious
B) It is governed by the pleasure principle
C) It balances biological and social demands
D) It is the moral aspect of personality

5 Wolkite University · Final 2015

Which of the following is considered the "internal diplomat" of psychic conflict?

A) Superego
B) Id
C) Ego
D) Ideal self

6 Arsi University · Final 2014

According to Freud, a person dominated by the ego is concerned mainly with rules and culture.

True / False

7 Arsi University · Final 2014

Which personality structure describes a woman who cries artificially at the funeral of a person she does not know?

A) Id
B) Ego
C) Superego
D) Libido

8 Jigjiga University · Final (Set A)

According to Freud, which part of personality predominates in a person who is severely drug-addicted?

A) Id
B) Conscience
C) Ego
D) Superego

9 Jigjiga University · Final (Set A)

Helping people in need is endorsed by which part of the personality structure?

A) Id
B) Ego
C) Ego ideal
D) Conscience

10 Arba Minch University · Final 2015

The conscience is the part of the superego that punishes us (with guilt) when we do something wrong.

True / False

11 Wolaita Sodo University · Final 2014

According to psychoanalytic theory, our behaviour is not freely chosen; it is determined by intra-psychic forces.

True / False

12 Bahir Dar University · Mid 2014

"The personality you have today is not the result of recent days; it is the cumulative effect of past experiences." This statement is advocated by which school of thought?

A) Humanistic
B) Gestalt
C) Psychodynamic
D) Cognitive

13 Wolaita Sodo University · Final 2014

In which psychosexual stage do children get satisfaction mainly by playing with peers and focusing on school activities?

- **A)** Phallic
- **B)** Oral
- **C)** Genital
- **D)** Latency

14 Wachemo University · Mid 2016

Freud believed unresolved conflicts during a psychosexual stage show up as personality traits later. What might a fixation at the oral stage look like in adulthood?

- **A)** Neatness and orderliness
- **B)** Dependency and smoking habits
- **C)** Perfectionism and high ambition
- **D)** Difficulty with abstract reasoning

15 Wachemo University · Mid 2016

According to Freud, which stage is critical for the development of gender identity?

- **A)** Oral
- **B)** Phallic
- **C)** Latency
- **D)** Genital

16 Wachemo University · Mid 2015

In Freud's theory, "erogenous zones" refer to:

- **A)** unconscious parts of the mind
- **B)** conscious elements of the mind
- **C)** parts of the body that serve as sources of pleasure at different stages
- **D)** brain areas controlling emotion

Answers & Explanations

1. B

reality

The ego satisfies the id realistically, avoiding negative consequences.

2. C

Superego

The superego is the moral centre of personality.

3. False

That describes the id. The ego develops later and is rational.

4. C

It balances biological and social demands

The ego mediates between the id's urges, reality and the superego. A and B describe the id; D the superego.

5. C

Ego

The ego negotiates between the id and the superego.

6. False

Concern with rules, morals and social norms is the superego. The ego is concerned with reality.

7. C

Superego

She is following social and moral expectations of how to behave at a funeral.

8. A

Id

Seeking immediate pleasure regardless of consequences is the id's pleasure principle.

9. D

Conscience

The conscience produces guilt when we fail to do right and pride when we do; it pushes us to help.

10. True

The conscience judges behaviour against the ego ideal and produces guilt or pride.

11. True

Freud saw behaviour as determined by unconscious inner forces.

12. C

Psychodynamic

Psychodynamic theory stresses that childhood experiences shape adult personality.

13. D

Latency

In latency, sexual urges are quiet and energy goes into social and intellectual skills.

14. B

Dependency and smoking habits

Oral fixation shows in mouth-related habits and dependency. Neatness relates to the anal stage.

15. B

Phallic

Resolving the Oedipus/Electra conflict in the phallic stage leads to identification with the same-sex parent.

16. C

parts of the body that serve as sources of pleasure at different stages

Each psychosexual stage centres on a different pleasure-giving body area.

CHAPTER 6 · LESSON 6.3

Defence Mechanisms

AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Define defence mechanisms and explain their purpose
- Describe the eight defence mechanisms with examples
- Identify the mechanism in complex scenario questions

6.3.1 What defence mechanisms are

D DEFENCE MECHANISMS

Unconscious tactics used by the **ego** to protect the person from **anxiety** caused by conflict between the id, superego and reality. They either keep threatening material out of awareness or **disguise** it. Everyone uses them; they become unhealthy only when used **excessively**, and they give only **temporary** relief.

F EIGHT DEFENCE MECHANISMS

Mechanism	What happens	Example
Repression	pushing threatening thoughts and memories **into the unconscious**	a husband who was humiliated in an argument "forgets" it completely
Denial	**refusing to recognize** a threatening reality	Mr. Geremew, an alcoholic, insists he has no drinking problem
Regression	going **back to childish** behaviour that once reduced anxiety	a child who starts school goes back to thumb-sucking or bed-wetting
Rationalization	giving **acceptable excuses** for unacceptable behaviour or failure	"I got bad grades because I care about knowledge, not grades"; "I never wanted that job anyway"
Displacement	taking feelings out on a **safer target**	angry at your boss, you shout at your family
Projection	**attributing your own** unacceptable feelings to **others**	a student who wants to cheat accuses classmates of being cheaters
Reaction formation	acting in the **opposite** way to your true feelings	someone attracted to a person keeps saying how unattractive that person is
Sublimation	channelling sexual or aggressive energy into **socially acceptable** activities	an aggressive young man becomes a dedicated football player or boxer

? THE DOJU CASE: THREE DEFENCES IN ONE STORY (ADAPTED FROM AN ARSI 2014 EXAM)

Titi and Lili both liked Doju. Doju chose Lili. Titi told her friends, "I didn't want him anyway; I need to focus on my studies." Since then, Titi constantly talks about Doju's unattractive qualities. Meanwhile Lili, who had promised another boy she would go out with him, felt guilty and began accusing that boy of being unfaithful.

- Titi's first reaction, an acceptable excuse for losing → **rationalization**.
- Titi's constant criticism of the person she actually likes, the opposite of her real feeling → **reaction formation**.
- Lili attributes her own unfaithfulness to the other boy → **projection**.
- Doju, choosing between two attractive girls, faced an **approach–approach conflict** (chapter 5).

  Rule of thumb: excuse → rationalization; opposite behaviour → reaction formation; "it's you, not me" → projection; wrong target → displacement; acceptable outlet → sublimation; "this isn't happening" → denial; childish behaviour → regression; forgotten → repression.

DEFENCE TRAPS

- Defence mechanisms are **unconscious**, not conscious tactics.
- They give **temporary** relief, not lasting solutions.
- **Repression** (motivated forgetting) and **denial** differ: repression removes the memory from awareness; denial refuses to accept a present reality.

Exam Practice

10 QUESTIONS · LESSON 6.3

1 Wolkite University · Final 2015

Repression is the process of pushing anxiety-arousing thoughts from the conscious mind into the unconscious mind.

True / False

2 Arba Minch University · Final 2015

Defence mechanisms are conscious tactics of the ego to manage the conflict between the id and the superego.

True / False

3 Arsi University · Final 2014

Defence mechanisms basically give us long-lasting relief from anxiety.

True / False

4 Arsi University · Final 2014 (case adapted)

"Since then, Titi constantly talks about Doju's unattractive qualities," although she actually likes him. Which defence mechanism does this imply?

A) Reaction formation **B)** Rationalization
C) Sublimation **D)** Denial

5 Arsi University · Final 2014 (case adapted)

After Doju chose Lili, Titi said, "I didn't want him anyway; I need to focus on my studies." Which defence did Titi use first?

A) Displacement **B)** Reaction formation
C) Sublimation **D)** Rationalization

6 Arsi University · Final 2014 (case adapted)

Lili, feeling guilty about breaking a promise to another boy, accuses him of being unfaithful. Which defence mechanism is she using?

A) Repression **B)** Projection
C) Displacement **D)** Regression

7 Model question (module)

Mr. Geremew drinks heavily every day but insists he does not have a drinking problem. This is:

A) Denial **B)** Projection
C) Sublimation **D)** Regression

8 Model question (module)

A worker who is criticized by his boss comes home and shouts at his children. This is:

A) Rationalization
B) Displacement
C) Reaction formation
D) Repression

9 Model question (module)

A seven-year-old starts wetting the bed again after his baby sister is born. This is:

A) Regression
B) Sublimation
C) Projection
D) Denial

10 Model question (module)

A young man with strong aggressive urges channels them into training as a boxer. This is:

A) Displacement
B) Sublimation
C) Reaction formation
D) Rationalization

Answers & Explanations

1. True

That is the definition of repression.

2. False

Defence mechanisms are unconscious.

3. False

The relief they provide is temporary; excessive use can create more stress.

4. A

Reaction formation

She behaves in the opposite way to her true feelings.

5. D

Rationalization

She gave a socially acceptable excuse to protect herself from the pain of rejection.

6. B

Projection

She attributes her own unacceptable behaviour or feeling to someone else.

7. A

Denial

He refuses to acknowledge a threatening reality.

8. B

Displacement

Anger is redirected from a threatening target (the boss) to a safer one (the children).

9. A

Regression

He returns to an earlier, childish behaviour under stress.

10. **B**

Sublimation

Aggressive energy is expressed through a socially acceptable outlet.

CHAPTER 6 · LESSON 6.4

Trait Theory: The Big Five

AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- State the three assumptions of trait theory
- Describe each Big Five (OCEAN) dimension at its high and low ends
- Classify behaviour descriptions into traits

6.4.1 Assumptions of trait theory

Trait theorists see personality as a **combination of stable internal characteristics** that people show **consistently** over time and across situations. They measure **how much** of each trait a person has.

1. Traits are relatively **stable over time**, so behaviour is predictable (a gentle person stays gentle).
2. Traits are relatively **stable across situations** (competitive at work and on the football pitch).
3. People **differ in the strength** and combination of each trait, so no two people are exactly alike.

6.4.2 The Big Five (five-factor model): OCEAN

THE BIG FIVE DIMENSIONS

Trait	High scorers are…	Low scorers are…
Openness	willing to try **new things**, curious, imaginative, enjoy other cultures	prefer routine and the status quo
Conscientiousness	**organized**, responsible, self-disciplined, punctual, careful with belongings	late, careless, borrow things and fail to return them
Extraversion	**outgoing, sociable**, enjoy attention (Carl **Jung** first used the term)	**introverted**: solitary, quiet, dislike being the centre of attention
Agreeableness	easygoing, friendly, pleasant, cooperative	grumpy, crabby, hard to get along with
Neuroticism	emotionally **unstable**: worried, anxious, moody	emotionally **stable**: calm, relaxed, secure, even-tempered

SPOT THE TRAIT

- Abdullah loves to travel and experience different cultures → high **openness**.
- Hana always submits assignments on time and keeps a neat planner → high **conscientiousness**.
- Daniel is the life of every party → high **extraversion**.
- Mr. Z is calm, secure, relaxed and self-satisfied → **low neuroticism**.
- "Worried, moody, anxious" all belong to high neuroticism; "calm" is the odd one out.

TRAIT TRAPS

- **Extraverts** are outgoing; **introverts** are solitary. A statement that reverses them is false.
- Antisocial behaviour is **not** a Big Five trait (it relates to a personality disorder, chapter 7).
- High **neuroticism** = emotional instability, not "being neurotic" in a clinical sense.

Exam Practice

8 QUESTIONS · LESSON 6.4

1 Arba Minch University · Final 2016

According to trait theory, which dimension describes a tendency to be organized, responsible and self-disciplined?

A) Extraversion
B) Conscientiousness
C) Agreeableness
D) Openness

2 Arsi University · Final 2014

Mr. Z is calm, secure, relaxed and self-satisfied. His score is most probably lowest on:

A) Openness
B) Conscientiousness
C) Extraversion
D) Neuroticism

3 Arsi University · Final 2014

Identify the odd one out from a personality-trait point of view.

A) Worried
B) Moody
C) Calm
D) Anxious

4 Jigjiga University · Final (Set A)

Abdullah tends to seek out and experience various cultures. This trait is related to:

A) Openness
B) Conscientiousness
C) Extraversion
D) Agreeableness

5 Jigjiga University · Final (Set A)

Which of the following is NOT one of the Big Five traits?

A) Openness
B) Extraversion
C) Neuroticism
D) Antisocial behaviour

6 Wolaita Sodo University · Final 2014

Introverts are outgoing and sociable, whereas extraverts are solitary and dislike being the centre of attention.

True / False

7 Arba Minch University · Final 2015

According to trait theories, the relative strength and combination of each trait differ from person to person.

True / False

8 Arsi University · Final 2014

According to psychoanalytic theory, our personality is a combination of stable and consistent personal traits.

True / False

Answers & Explanations

1. B

Conscientiousness

Conscientiousness covers organization, responsibility and self-discipline.

2. D

Neuroticism

Calm, secure and relaxed are the low end of neuroticism (emotional stability).

3. C

Calm

Worried, moody and anxious are high neuroticism; calm is low neuroticism.

4. A

Openness

Openness is willingness to try new things and new experiences.

5. D

Antisocial behaviour

The Big Five are openness, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness and neuroticism.

6. False

It is the reverse.

7. True

This is one of the three assumptions of trait theory.

8. False

That is the trait view. Psychoanalytic theory explains personality by unconscious conflicts among id, ego and superego.

CHAPTER 6 · LESSON 6.5

The Humanistic Theory of Personality



AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Explain the humanistic "third force" and its view of human nature
- Explain Rogers' self-concept, real self and ideal self
- Distinguish conditional and unconditional positive regard
- Explain the fully functioning person and self-actualization

6.5.1 The third force

In the mid-twentieth century, reacting against the **pessimism** of Freud (unconscious, animal urges) and the **external control** of behaviourism, humanistic psychology arose as the **third force**. It emphasizes **inherent goodness**, **free will**, conscious choice, uniqueness and the tendency to **grow** toward higher functioning. Main figures: **Carl Rogers** and **Abraham Maslow**.

6.5.2 Carl Rogers and the self-concept

KEY IDEAS OF ROGERS

- **Self-actualizing tendency:** the innate striving to fulfil all our capacities.
- **Self-concept:** the image we have of ourselves, formed largely from how **significant others** (parents, siblings, teachers, friends) react to us.
- **Real self:** how we actually see our characteristics and abilities. **Ideal self:** what we think we **should be** or would like to be (mostly from parents).
- **Congruence:** when real and ideal selves are close, we feel competent. **Incongruence** (a large mismatch) leads to **anxiety** and neurotic behaviour.

CONDITIONAL VS UNCONDITIONAL POSITIVE REGARD

	Unconditional positive regard	Conditional positive regard
Meaning	love, warmth and respect **with no strings attached**	love and respect that **depend on** doing what others want
Effect	freedom to explore potential; positive self-concept; leads to being **fully functioning** and self-actualization	the person becomes what others want, not what he or she is; blocks growth
Module example	**Tirhas**'s parents: "Become whatever you want; we will love you no matter what"	**Chaltu**'s parents made it clear she must become a doctor or lose their love

FULLY FUNCTIONING PERSON

For Rogers, a person who is actively exploring potentials and experiencing a match between real and ideal selves is **fully functioning**: in touch with feelings, trusting inner urges. Being fully functioning is a necessary step toward **self-actualization**. Maslow's examples of self-actualized people include Einstein, Gandhi, Eleanor Roosevelt, and (added by the module) Nelson Mandela.

HUMANISTIC TRAPS

- Humanistic theory does **not** emphasize irrational, aggressive or sexual drives (that is psychoanalysis).
- Psychological disorder, for humanists, comes from **blocked growth** and **incongruence** between self-concept and reality.
- Humanistic psychology gives **students greater responsibility** for their own learning.

Exam Practice

9 QUESTIONS · LESSON 6.5

1 Arba Minch University · Final 2016

Carl Rogers emphasized that a positive self-concept is promoted by:

A) unconditional positive regard
B) a sense of control
C) self-actualization
D) conditional positive regard

2 Jigjiga University · Final (Set A)

Tibabu respects his son's choices and shows him love without expecting anything in return. Tibabu is giving:

A) conditional positive regard
B) unconditional positive regard
C) an ideal self-concept
D) a real self-concept

3 Wolaita Sodo University · Final 2014

According to Carl Rogers, unconditional positive regard is a key to achieving self-actualization.

True / False

4 Wolkite University · Final 2015

The humanistic theory of personality emphasizes the irrational aspects of behaviour and portrays aggressive and sexual needs as having a major impact on personality.

True / False

5 Jigjiga University · Final (Set A)

According to humanistic theory, psychological disorder results from:

A) genetic abnormality
B) conflict between the id and superego
C) blocked personal growth and incongruence between self-concept and reality
D) conditioning and learning

6 Haramaya University · Mid 2015

Usmael's parents believe in his uniqueness and in his reaching his full potential. This reflects which perspective?

A) Cognitive
B) Socio-cultural
C) Biological
D) Humanistic

7 Arsi University · Final 2013

Which perspective gives students greater responsibility for their own learning?

A) Humanistic
B) Behaviourism
C) Psychodynamic
D) Socio-cultural

8 Model question (module)

Chaltu's parents made it clear from childhood that she must become a doctor or lose their love and respect. According to Rogers:

A) she received unconditional positive regard and will be fully functioning
B) she received conditional positive regard and is less free to explore her potential
C) her id controls her personality
D) she has high conscientiousness

9 Model question (module)

According to Rogers, anxiety and neurotic behaviour result when:

A) the real self and ideal self are very similar
B) there is a large mismatch between the real self and the ideal self
C) a person receives unconditional positive regard
D) the superego is weak

Answers & Explanations

1. A

unconditional positive regard

Love and respect with no conditions let a person explore and grow freely.

2. B

unconditional positive regard

Love with no strings attached is unconditional positive regard.

3. True

It allows a person to become fully functioning, a step toward self-actualization.

4. False

That describes psychoanalytic theory. Humanistic theory emphasizes goodness, free will and growth.

5. C

blocked personal growth and incongruence between self-concept and reality

A mismatch between real and ideal self, and blocked growth, cause anxiety. A = biological; B = psychoanalytic; D = behavioural.

6. D

Humanistic

Uniqueness and full potential (self-actualization) are humanistic ideas.

7. A

Humanistic

Humanists stress free will and self-direction.

8. B

she received conditional positive regard and is less free to explore her potential

Love that depends on meeting others' wishes is conditional; it limits self-exploration.

9. **B**

there is a large mismatch between the real self and the ideal self

Incongruence between real and ideal selves produces anxiety.

CHAPTER 6 · QUICK REVISION

Personality — at a glance

CHAPTER 6 AT A GLANCE

Topic	Must-know points
Personality	persona (mask); unique enduring pattern; character = moral judgement; temperament = inborn
Freud	id (birth, unconscious, pleasure principle, libido); ego (reality principle, executive, balances); superego (moral; ego ideal + conscience)
Stages	oral (weaning), anal (toilet training), phallic (gender identity), latency (quiet, school and play), genital
Defences	unconscious, temporary: repression, denial, regression, rationalization, displacement, projection, reaction formation, sublimation
Traits	stable over time and situations; Big Five OCEAN: openness, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness, neuroticism
Humanistic	third force; Rogers: self-concept, real vs ideal self, congruence; unconditional vs conditional positive regard; fully functioning → self-actualization

THE BIG FIVE: OCEAN

Open to new things · **C**areful and organized · **E**xtraverted and social · **A**greeable and kind · **N**ervous and moody (neuroticism).